

How to Use: Budget Planner

A buyer-friendly guide for getting the most value from the Budget Planner spreadsheet and printable PDF.

Purpose	Helps the buyer map income, fixed expenses, variable spending, savings, and leftover money in one clear monthly budget.
Best for	Beginners who want control over where their money is going each pay cycle.

What to enter

- Monthly income
- Fixed bills and due dates
- Variable expenses such as food, fuel, and spending
- Savings amount or percentage
- Notes for upcoming one-off costs

Step-by-step instructions

1. Start with take-home income, not gross salary.
2. Enter fixed expenses first because these are non-negotiable.
3. Add realistic variable spending based on recent bank history.
4. Use the remaining balance to decide savings, debt payoff, or buffer.
5. Review at the end of each month and adjust the next month based on what actually happened.

Quick tips for best results

- Keep the first month simple; accuracy improves after one full cycle.
- Do not delete formulas; only edit input cells.
- Use the PDF version for planning on paper and the spreadsheet version for automatic totals.

Spreadsheet vs printable PDF

Spreadsheet version	Printable PDF version
Use for automatic totals, formulas, and ongoing edits.	Use for printing, handwriting, or adding to a workbook bundle.
Only edit input cells and keep formulas intact.	Print at actual size or fit-to-page depending on printer settings.

Product positioning note

Recommended bundle pathway: Pairs well with Payday Account Splitter and Bill & Subscription Tracker. This helps buyers move from planning to consistent action.